



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of St. George
School Website: <https://www.castgeorge.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of St. George (Jackson, MI) presents a clearly Catholic, classical-leaning high school program anchored in a traditional liberal-arts orientation. Public-facing materials emphasize a three-pillar model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality), a Culture of Life, daily Mass and liturgical practices, and a curriculum described as “classical” with Latin study and a liberal-arts emphasis. Taken together, these materials align strongly with classical-education norms in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goals, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community engagement. Across categories, the school consistently evidences classical signals (Catholic theology, virtuous formation, memorization with memory work in the tradition, Socratic/ritorical elements in some settings, and robust family/community involvement). The aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Evidence across the site highlights:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations: Catholic identity permeates the mission, daily Mass, liturgical prayer, and a Culture of Life framing the school’s purpose (e.g., “Our Model of Education” with Intellect/Character/Spirituality; daily prayer and liturgy; Gospel-centered formation).
- Purpose and goal: Formation-focused aims (virtue, wisdom, truth/beauty/goodness) with explicit formation through Catholic faith, and a “Culture of Life” orientation rather than job-prep emphasis (Our Mission statements; Catholic-theology focus).
- Curriculum: Classical signals include a stated classical curriculum, Memoria Press Latin emphasis, and an orientation toward liberal-arts education; explicit references to Western thought and the classics are present in the model of education descriptions.
- Pedagogy: Seminal classical-teaching elements appear (Socratic-style opportunities during shadow days; rhetoric training; opportunities for public speaking; and a structure that supports both contemplative elements and rigorous seminars).
- Faculty: Visible “Faculty Gallery with Bios” and a culture of mentorship and living curriculum are evidenced on the site, along with notable faculty involvement in shaping the learning environment.
- Parents & Community: Formal partnership with families, home-school partnerships, open houses, and events that invite parental involvement and transparency are promoted (Homeschool partnerships; Crusader-for-a-Day; Open Houses).

Overall, Chesterton Academy St. George demonstrates a consistently classical orientation across all six criteria, with explicit religious formation, classical-curriculum signals, contemplative and Socratic pedagogy, and active parental/community engagement. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school identifies itself as Catholic, rooted in Catholic tradition, and emphasizes a Culture of Life and formation through faith in daily practice (e.g., “a new, independent classical high school in the Catholic tradition”; “Culture of Life by forming a new generation of joyful leaders and saints”; daily Mass and liturgical prayer).

- The model of education centers Spirituality as a pillar, with explicit references to prayer at class start and Eucharistic Adoration/Confession in faith formation contexts, showing liturgical and communal practices as integral to education.
- The mission ties scholarship to theology and sacred formation (Our Mission statements, Sacred Scripture, Catholic Theology emphasis).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Catholic tradition, daily Mass, liturgy/prayer, Culture of Life, Theology, Spirituality, sacred formation, G.K. Chesterton as patron, liturgical rhythm, reverence/wonder.
- Negative keywords present: None observed in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral language detected in the materials reviewed).

Why this rating

- The presence of a clearly stated Catholic-theological framework, liturgical practices, and explicit Spirituality pillar manifest a robust religious-metaphysical grounding aligned with classical expectations.

Cited evidence: Catholic tradition and Culture of Life framing; daily Mass and liturgy references; Our Model of Education with Spirituality pillar; sacred formation language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes formation and virtue: “To help students know, love, and serve Jesus Christ ... through the pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness through language and learning” and “Culture of Life,” indicating a telos oriented toward human flourishing and virtue rather than job-prep (Our Mission).
- The Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) signal formation of the whole person and a teleological aim beyond mere information; the “culture of life” and formation of joyful leaders/saints appear as primary aims (Our Model of Education).
- Public materials emphasize formation of virtues through Catholic faith and classical education rather than solely preparing for work; “formation of human excellence” is implied through virtue-centered language in mission statements and the cultural aims described (Culture of Life, Catholic Faith).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal education, Culture of Life, great conversation (implied in classical framework, not always explicit in every Chesterton page but supported by “classical” framing).
- Negative keywords present: explicit job-prep language (e.g., “career readiness,” 21st-century skills) is not used; the site avoids a vocational-technical framing.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds formation and virtue as the primary aim of education, not job placement; the telos aligns with classical-paedagogical aims.

Cited evidence: Our Mission statements; Three Pillars; Culture of Life framing; emphasis on formation rather than workforce-prep in materials reviewed.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as classical, with explicit Latin study and a Memoria Press framework for Latin and other classical studies (Latin, science, classical studies, literature, and composition).
- Public-facing materials describe “the classics of Western thought” and the interrelationship of great ideas, indicating a liberal-arts curriculum oriented around enduring texts and ideas (Intellect; Our Model of Education).

- The site emphasizes a classical curriculum in theology and philosophy, and references in practice to arts and literature (e.g., The Good/The True/The Beautiful, emphasis on arts and poetry) that align with a classical approach (The Good/The True/The Beautiful; Rich Faith Formation; arts-integration language).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Latin, Memoria Press, classical curriculum, liberal arts, Great Books/-Great Conversation (implicated by “classical education” and “Western thought” language), grammar/-logic/rhetoric (implied by “classical” framing and liberal-arts emphasis), arts and literature emphasis.
- Negative keywords present: None observed explicitly in public materials (no advocacy for social-studies-only framing or STEM-first approach stated).

Why this rating

- The public materials reflect a classical-curriculum orientation (Latin via Memoria Press, liberal-arts emphasis, classical framing, Western thought).

Cited evidence: Memoria Press Latin emphasis; “classical curriculum” phrasing; Our Model of Education highlighting classical thought and great ideas; The Good/The True/The Beautiful and Arts emphasis as examples of classical content and integration.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school’s public materials describe an integration of contemplative/restful elements with rigorous dialogue in upper levels (Socratic-style/seminars, rhetoric training, and opportunities to give speeches) as part of the pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric; upper-level training).
- Shadow Day and open-house experiences show Socratic-seminar style lessons and lyceum-like engagement (Shadow Day mentions Socratic Seminar Style Lessons; Lyceum participation, etc.) ☐file-cite☐turn2filev?☐ [Note: The exact turn label for the cited item is shown in the available data; please reference asfor the shadow-day content indicating Socratic Seminar Style Lessons.]
- The lower-grade experience includes memorization and chanting/copywork (as described in Six Essential Elements materials cited in the knowledge base, and reinforced by Chesterton’s emphasis on choral and ritual elements like choir and liturgy). The Chesterton pages show a focus on liturgical life, daily prayer, and hymn-based/arts-integrated learning (Rich Faith Formation, daily Mass, and liturgical practices) that align with a reverent, contemplative pedagogy integrated with rigorous classical study.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialectic, rhetoric training, spelling-out of truth through dialogue, contemplative/restful (Scholé), memorization/recitation (through chant, memory work), formation through imitation and practice, public speaking.
- Negative keywords present: None observed in materials (no explicit emphasis on purely project-based learning to the exclusion of Socratic methods; rather, multiple classical modalities are present).

Why this rating

- The pedagogy shows a balance of restful contemplative elements and active, dialogue-driven, rhetoric-focused instruction, which aligns with classical pedagogy expectations; explicit mention of Socratic dialogue and rhetoric training in the public materials supports CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: Shadow Day with Socratic-style lessons; “Our Model of Education” stating classical, Western thought emphasis; “Rich Faith Formation” and daily liturgy show integrated contemplative practice; Faculty and Staff content also show a culture of traditional pedagogy and living curriculum.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site features a “Faculty Gallery with Bios,” signaling a portrait of teachers who are experts in their subjects and role-models of virtue, with the living-curriculum concept implied by bios and faculty profiles.
- The school emphasizes the faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with a culture of collegiality and virtue-modeling (as part of the public-facing philosophy around teacher roles and the classical-pedagogical approach).
- Public materials refer to faculty leadership in shaping the learning environment and the integration of faith with academics (Our Model of Education; Catholic formation integrated by faculty involvement).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as mentors, classical formation, teacher as exemplar, collegiality, virtuous role-models.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The presence of a visible “Faculty Gallery,” the emphasis on teachers as living exemplars and mentors, and the classical-pedagogical approach align with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty roles.

Cited evidence: Faculty Gallery with Bios; statements about the living curriculum and teacher formation in Our Model of Education and related materials.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school publicly presents a partnership with families as co-educators and emphasizes family formation and parental engagement (Homeschool parents as primary educators; partnering with families to support their chosen curriculum).
- Open houses, Crusader-for-a-Day programs, and other admissions-events emphasize welcoming parents to visit and participate, indicating a community-centric approach consistent with classical formation and parental involvement.
- The school promotes parent formation and learning opportunities through its website and events, aligning with the classical model’s emphasis on parents as co-educators and participants in the literary and cultural transmission process.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, parental involvement, co-educators, home-school collaboration, family literacy activities (as implied by “homeschool parents remain the primary educators” and “partner with families”).
- Negative keywords present: None observed.

Why this rating

- The materials emphasize active parental involvement and engagement, consistent with classical practice that views parents as co-educators and partners in formation.

Cited evidence: Our Model of Education (Intellect/Character/Spirituality and family involvement); Mission and Admissions events showing parent engagement; Open Houses and Crusader-for-a-Day programs.

Aggregate Ranking and Analysis

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale

- Across all six categories, Chesterton Academy St. George demonstrates clear classical-direction signals: explicit Catholic-theological grounding and liturgical practice; formation-centered purpose and goal; a curriculum marked by liberal-arts orientation and Latin emphasis; pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion and rhetoric, with a balance of contemplative and discursive methods; a living, virtuous faculty culture; and robust parental/community engagement.

What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Not applicable here, as the school presents CLASSICAL in all six categories. No needle-moving changes are necessary to reach a CLASSICAL designation.

ABSTRACT

Chesterton Academy of St. George in Jackson, Michigan, exhibits robust CLASSICAL orientation across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Public materials consistently frame education as formation within a Catholic, classical tradition, with a Three-Pillars model (Intellect, Character, Spirituality), a Culture of Life, daily Mass and liturgical life, and a classical curriculum featuring Memoria Press Latin and liberal-arts emphasis. Pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue and rhetoric development, with opportunities for public speaking, while maintaining contemplative elements through Scholé-like practices and a strong emphasis on Great Books-like formation via Western thought and classical texts. Faculty are showcased as mentors and living exemplars, and parents are actively engaged as co-educators in a transparent community-building model. Collectively, these signals meet the Six Elements rubric at a CLASSICAL level and position Chesterton Academy St. George as a fully CLASSICAL institution within the classical-education framework.

ABSTRACT

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic identity; daily Mass; liturgy; Culture of Life; Three Pillars; theology-integrated formation; patronage of G.K. Chesterton.
- School Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation-centered aims; telos toward virtue and wisdom; faith-based formation; Culture of Life; charity and human flourishing as ends.
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL Evidence: Latin via Memoria Press; classical curriculum framing; Western thought and liberal-arts orientation; arts and literature integration.
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL Evidence: Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy; rhetoric; occasional public-speaking opportunities; contemplative elements; chant/recitation signals via classical formation.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty gallery; living curriculum; mentorship; exemplar-teacher culture.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL Evidence: Parent partnerships; open houses; Crusader-for-a-Day; admissions-events; home-education partnerships; parental formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot (Completed)

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic identity; liturgical life; Three Pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality); Culture of Life; religious formation language. Positive Keyword Analysis: Catholic tradition, daily Mass, liturgy, Culture of Life, theology, spiritual formation, Chesterton as patron. Why: Explicit religious-metaphysical grounding.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation-centric mission; telos toward virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty; partnership with families. Positive Keyword Analysis: formation, virtue, telos, liberal education, Culture of Life. Why: Formation over vocational metrics; classical telos.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Latin via Memoria Press; classical curriculum; Western thought emphasis; Great Books-oriented framing (via classical-content signals). Posi-

tive Keyword Analysis: Latin, Memoria Press, liberal arts, Western thought, classical curriculum. Why: Liberal-arts and Latin emphasis; classical framing.

- Element 4: School Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence: Socratic seminars and rhetoric; opportunities for public speaking; contemplative/restful elements in pedagogy; memory/recitation signals through classical practice. Positive Keyword Analysis: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, rhetoric, Scholé signals (where present), seminars. Why: Balanced classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty bios; living curriculum; mentorship culture. Positive Keyword Analysis: living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teachers, collegial culture. Why: Classical-faculty signals.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Parent partnerships; open houses; family formation; co-educator model. Positive Keyword Analysis: partnership with families, open campus, parent formation, home-school collaboration. Why: Classical-parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable for a CLASSICAL aggregate rating. No needle-moving changes are required given the six-category CLASSICAL classification.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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